

HOUSE RESOLUTION 240

By Pearson

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Memphis Rox for its transformative impact on community, equity, and opportunity in Memphis and across the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body recognize those institutions that uplift communities, restore hope, and create pathways to opportunity for all people; and

WHEREAS, Memphis Rox, located in the Soulsville community of South Memphis, stands as the largest nonprofit climbing gym in the world but, more importantly, as a beacon of healing, belonging, and human connection; and

WHEREAS, Memphis Rox was founded on the belief that access to wellness, recreation, and community should never be determined by one's ability to pay, operating under a "pay-what-you-can" model that ensures no person is turned away; and

WHEREAS, through its innovative and compassionate approach, Memphis Rox uses climbing not merely as sport but as a powerful metaphor for overcoming life's obstacles and fostering resilience, confidence, and unity among people of all backgrounds; and

WHEREAS, the organization provides far more than a climbing facility, offering holistic programming including youth mentorship, job training, after-school enrichment, fitness and wellness classes, and community service initiatives that directly invest in the lives of underserved youth and families; and

WHEREAS, Memphis Rox actively cultivates a diverse and inclusive environment, intentionally breaking down racial, cultural, and socioeconomic barriers while creating a safe and welcoming space where every individual is valued and empowered; and

WHEREAS, the organization's impact extends beyond recreation, addressing food insecurity through community meals and gardens, supporting neighborhood revitalization efforts, and fostering meaningful relationships that strengthen the social fabric of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, through volunteerism and community engagement, Memphis Rox has inspired thousands of acts of service, demonstrating that collective action and shared responsibility can transform entire communities; and

WHEREAS, Memphis Rox embodies the spirit of Tennessee by lifting up those most often left behind and proving that when barriers are removed, communities can rise together in strength, dignity, and hope; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Memphis Rox for its outstanding commitment to community empowerment, equity, and holistic well-being.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.